Distribution Module — Overview

> ***Order to outlet, one trail.*** *Brand → Distributor → Field Salesman → Outlet → Consumer*

What it is

A complete digital backbone for FMCG distribution. From the brand setting prices to the consumer picking the product off the shelf, every step is captured, priced correctly, paid for, and audited — on one platform.

Today, distribution leaks happen at every handoff: a salesman writes a wrong price, a scheme gets misapplied, a cheque goes missing, returns get fudged, ledgers don't tie. This module closes those gaps end-to-end.

The five steps

1 · Brand

Plan, targets, prices. The brand team sets up products with GST details, defines who can buy at what price (modern trade vs general trade vs wholesale), and rolls out trade schemes — buy-one-get-one, slab discounts, value offers, free goods.

Every price list and scheme is **versioned** — change it tomorrow and old orders still show what they were sold at, forever.

2 · Distributor

Stock, billing, schemes. Distributors see their open orders, dispatched goods, paid invoices, and ageing receivables (0–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+ days) at a glance. The billing summary tells them exactly which outlets are healthy and which are slipping into late payment.

3 · Field Salesman

Order capture, payment, returns. The salesman opens the app, taps an outlet from today's beat plan, and captures an order in **three taps** — the cart is pre-populated with the last few orders and shelf-gap recommendations. Schemes and taxes are calculated automatically. Payment can be

collected on the spot — cash, UPI QR, cheque (with mandatory photo), or against credit. Returns require a photo and a reason; large returns escalate to a supervisor.

Works offline. A salesman in a basement market with no signal can still book the order; it syncs the moment connectivity returns, with no risk of double-booking.

4 · Outlet

Delivered, billed, audited. Approved orders convert to a tax-correct invoice (GSTIN, HSN, CGST/ SGST/ IGST, IRN-ready). Goods are grouped onto a vehicle dispatch — anything above ₹50,000 automatically requires an e-way bill before it can leave. On delivery, the driver captures a Proof-of-Delivery photo and the shopkeeper's signature; the invoice is then closed against the outlet's ledger.

5 · Consumer

On-shelf, in-hand. Even after the goods reach the outlet, the loop closes. Salesmen capture shelf compliance via the existing planogram module, and outlet-level "off-take" (how many units actually sold to consumers) gets reported per SKU, per period. Brands finally see **what's selling** versus **what's sitting on the shelf**.

What each persona gets

Brands

- One source of truth for prices, schemes, and targets across all distributors
- Visibility into actual consumer off-take, not just what was billed to distributors
- Confidence that schemes are applied exactly as designed — no manual error, no manipulation

Distributors

- Faster invoicing, fewer disputes, automatic e-way bills above the legal threshold
- Real-time view of outstanding receivables and ageing
- Cheque tracking with mandatory photo capture — no more "where did that cheque go?"

Field Salesmen

- Three-tap order capture, even in a no-signal market
- Smart recommendations based on the outlet's last orders and shelf gaps
- Automatic tax + scheme calculation — no mental math, no errors
- Same screen for collecting payment and recording returns

Outlets

- Tax-correct invoices that match what they ordered
- Clear running balance against their credit limit
- Photo + signature delivery proof — no "I never got that" disputes

Operations & Finance

- Complete audit trail of every action — who did what, when, from where
- Double-entry ledger that physically cannot go negative (without an admin override that's itself logged)
- Ageing reports, GMV dashboards, scheme-spend visibility — all in one place

---

Loopholes this closes

Every fraud pattern we've seen in distribution has a specific guard:

Risk	What stops it
Salesman quotes wrong price to favour a friendly outlet	Server always re-calculates the price; the salesman's number is rejected if it differs by more than 1 paisa
Same order entered twice (network glitch, duplicate tap)	Every confirmation gets a unique key — replays return the original order, never a duplicate
Cheque collected and never deposited	Cheque payment is rejected unless a photo of the cheque is attached, taken via the app's camera
Ghost orders booked from outside the outlet	Every order is GPS-stamped; orders captured outside the outlet's geofence are flagged for supervisor review
Salesman books beyond their authority	Daily caps and per-order caps stop oversize orders before they hit the system
Outlet returns inflated to wipe out a debt	Returns require a photo of the goods and a reason code; large returns escalate to a supervisor
Selling on credit beyond the agreed limit	The ledger physically refuses to push past the credit limit unless an admin explicitly overrides — and that override is itself logged

Scheme rules quietly changed mid-cycle	Schemes are versioned; old orders stay priced under the version they were booked with, and every application is logged for audit
e-way bill skipped on a large dispatch	Above ₹50,000, the system blocks dispatch from leaving until an e-way bill is attached
Delivery never actually happened	Delivery requires a photo + signature on file; both are captured at the outlet

---

What's running today

The module is built and tested across four parts of the platform:

- **Backend API** — handles all the rules, math, and storage
- **Web Dashboard** — for brand, distributor, and operations teams
- **Android app** — for field salesmen
- **iOS app** — for field salesmen

A working demo dataset is already loaded in staging (one brand, one distributor, three SKUs, two outlets, one salesman) and a complete order-to-invoice-to-payment cycle has been smoke-tested end-to-end.

What's next

A few business decisions are still open before we go live with real customers:

1. **GST e-invoice provider** — we need to pick a registered partner (NIC sandbox, ClearTax, or Cygnet) to generate live IRN numbers instead of the test placeholder we have today.
2. **e-way bill provider** — same decision; same options.
3. **UPI gateway** — Razorpay and PhonePe both work; we just need to pick one for production.
4. **Scheme rules** — confirm with the brand team how stacking should work when multiple schemes target the same SKU.
5. **Returns window** — the default is 30 days; some brands may want shorter or longer.

Once those five decisions land, we can flip live with the first pilot distributor.

In one sentence

This module turns distribution from a handful of WhatsApp groups, paper chits, and Excel sheets into a single, accountable digital trail — designed so that a salesman, a distributor, and a brand owner all see the same numbers, on the same day, with no room for them to disagree.